

JUDGE FAQ

Do I need a PhD to judge?

No. A bachelor's degree or equivalent professional experience in a STEM field is sufficient. Judges come from industry, healthcare, education, trades, and research.

What if a project is outside my expertise?

A general STEM background is all you need. Focus on the process: how the student defined the problem, designed the experiment, handled data, and reasoned about results.

How long does judging take?

Plan on 3 to 5 hours, including orientation, interviews, and scoring. The awards ceremony is optional.

What should I wear?

Business casual works for every FairGame event.

Can I bring a colleague?

Yes. New judges are always welcome. Have your colleague register through the judge application so we can run their background check and send event details.

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Do I get lunch?

Lunch is usually provided at district and state events. Your event confirmation will say for sure.

Is there parking?

Parking details arrive with your event information email about one week before the fair.

What if I need to cancel?

Contact us as soon as you can at fairgameinitiative@outlook.com. Project assignments depend on judge count, so early notice matters.

Do corporate volunteer hours count?

Yes. Judging counts toward corporate volunteer hour programs, and we can confirm your hours in writing on request.

How do I sign up for the next event?

Register once through the judge application on fairgameinitiative.org/volunteer.html. We contact you when a fair near you needs judges.
